

Nikhil Rao

Data Scientist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Scientist with a background in applied mathematics, specializing in building end-to-end ML pipelines for finance and risk analytics.

SKILLS

- Python, R
- Machine learning (XGBoost, Random Forest, SVM)
- Risk modeling & credit scoring
- SQL, Spark for big data processing
- Model deployment (Flask, Docker)
- Statistical modeling & forecasting
- Data visualization (Seaborn, Plotly)
- MLOps basics (MLflow)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist — CreditWise Finance

Feb 2022 - Present

- Built a credit risk scoring model using XGBoost, improving default prediction accuracy by 12% over the baseline model
- Processed and analyzed transactional datasets exceeding 10M rows using PySpark
- Deployed ML models as REST APIs using Flask and Docker for integration with the loan approval system
- Presented quarterly model performance reviews to senior stakeholders and regulators

Data Science Intern — Quantra Analytics

Jan 2021 - Dec 2021

- Built exploratory data analysis reports identifying key drivers of loan default for the risk team
- Assisted in feature engineering for fraud detection models

PROJECTS

Fraud Detection System

Built an anomaly detection model using Isolation Forest to flag suspicious financial transactions in real time

Stock Price Prediction

Time-series LSTM model to forecast short-term stock price movement using historical data

EDUCATION

M.Sc, Data Science — BITS Pilani

2019 - 2021

B.Sc, Statistics — Hyderabad Central University

2016 - 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Scientist Associate
- DataCamp - Machine Learning Scientist Track